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Saving us from taking the bait, Facebook tweaks algorithms to cut down on "click bait" and show more relevant stuff. <http://dgit.in/FbkCbt>



LG's mini-projector

LG's PH450U is a tiny monster that can project an 80-inch picture at \$650. dgit.in/LGProj

LAVA X81

The Lava X81 is another good looking phone in the budget segment but does not have the right resume to be the best phone. Most of the specifications of the phone are borrowed from Lava's old V5 smartphone but the X81 brings an all new inspired design. The Lava X81 harks back to the age old design of the iPhone 3GS. Yes, the design might be age old but Lava has done a good job recreating it. The curved back combined with the contoured glass on the front makes the phone quite ergonomic and quite easy to use with one hand. Although, the quality of the plastics used is not up to the mark and is prone to scratches. In comparison, most budget smartphones these days offer a metal build, which is much more durable.

The phone features an average display with low sunlight visibility and brightness. However, this is the only phone in our shootout to feature a 5-inch display, albeit offering a resolution of only 720p. The smaller screen size in combination with the 2.5D curved display makes it quite ergonomic and easier to use. The custom Star OS3.0 UI on the other hand, which is layered on top of Android 6.0 Marshmallow does not add much to the whole experience. On top of that, the lack of a fingerprint scanner at its price, takes some points off.

The X81 doesn't get any better in the performance department as the age old MediaTek MT6735 SoC is a decent performer at best. It was seen earlier this year on the Coolpad Note 3 Lite which costs ₹7,000 and

offers a fingerprint scanner as well. While the phone can perform all core functionalities of a smartphone such as calling, playing Full HD content, streaming music, running apps or just playing mobile games, it does so with some lag and occasional stutter. The 13MP rear camera on the phone is no good either and images taken lack details and color saturation.

XIAOMI REDMI NOTE 3

The Xiaomi Redmi Note 3 is the best performing phone in this shootout and not just



Xiaomi Redmi Note 3

that, the 4050mAh battery ensures an all day battery life without any hassles. The only subtle part about this phone is certainly its design. The Redmi Note 3 follows a very simple design language offering a metal body with nicely rounded edges. The fit and finish of buttons and materials is nothing extraor-

inary but the choice of materials do make the phone seem sturdy, although a Gorilla Glass display is absent.

Powering the device is the very powerful Qualcomm Snapdragon 650 SoC. This hexa-core SoC combined with 2GB of RAM is able to provide the best performance in a budget segment. It is also the best performing smartphone in this shootout. This means, no matter what you throw at it, the phone hardly slows down. Further, heat issues due to constant gaming are also kept at minimum, adding more to the battery life.

Talking about the battery life, it is efficient and has a very heavy duty battery. Also, unlike many other smartphones, the Redmi Note 3 packs a high density 4050mAh battery. This means the battery takes less space and is able to provide day's worth of usage. The 16MP rear camera on the other hand is only able to take good images in well-lit conditions. The camera seems to struggle in low lighting and even indoor lighting.

MEIZU M3 NOTE

Last year, the Meizu M2 Note was the best phone in the sub-11K segment, but with new smartphones in the competition, things have changed. To compete, Meizu came out with the M3 Note. Starting with the design, the Meizu M3 Note is a beautiful looking phone. Meizu likes to keep the design of its phones similar across various price points and the M3 Note is no different. From first glance the phone may seem like an iPhone 6S but the M3 Note shares more design similarities with last

year's MX5. That said, the build quality along with the fit and finish of buttons is top notch. Although, the single home-cum-back-cum-fingerprint scanner requires some getting use to.

Meizu's Flyme UI is really likeable and now offers a much simpler interface than last year's iteration. The 5.5-inch display is also quite good and offers one of the best viewing angles and colour saturation, one can find on a budget phone. However, the overall brightness of the display and sunlight legibility is sub-optimal.

The device is powered by a MediaTek Helio P10 SoC. This is a fairly new SoC and the phone is able to offer a good performance until you start gaming on it. Yes, the phone does not like taxing tasks such as gaming. In our tests with Asphalt 8: Airborne, the phone constantly stuttered and lagged. That said, the phone is able to deal with less demanding games such as Alto's Adventure without any issues.

The key highlight of this device however is its battery life. This 8.2mm thin device packs a whopping 4100mAh battery providing more than a day of usage. It falls just short of the Xiaomi Redmi Note 3.

ASUS ZENFONE MAX (2016)

The Asus Zenfone Max is meant to be the phone for consumer who requires more than a day of battery life. The big 5.5-inch device packs a huge 5000mAh battery, which is the largest battery pack in this shootout. This is the second iteration of this phone with a more powerful